

Katoolin: Installing Kali Linux Tools on a Debian-based OS

In this article, we feature Katoolin, a script that facilitates the installation of Kali Linux tools on Kali Linux or a Linux distribution of your choice. With Katoolin, the user can also add or remove Kali Linux repositories.



Kali Linux is a Debian-based Linux security distribution for those whose main concern is security – primarily, penetration testing, security auditing, forensics and reverse engineering. It has over 600 tools to aid in professional hacking. Though generally not used as an ‘everyday’ operating system, it is specifically engineered for professional pen testing and security auditing. As such, it is not for first-time Linux users.

But, what if you want to experiment with penetration testing or you just want a taste of Kali Linux tools but are not willing to leave the comfort of your operating system? What if you want the best of both worlds? This is where the Katoolin tool comes in handy.

Katoolin is a script that installs all Kali Linux tools in your Debian-based operating system. All you need is Python 2.7 and the Git package installed in your system. Using this script, you can add and remove Kali Linux repositories.

In this article, there will be a brief introduction to Kali Linux and a tutorial on the installation of the Katoolin script in a Linux system. Later, there is a short guide on how to use Katoolin too. Ubuntu 14.04 64-bit will be used to guide you through the installation.

An introduction to Kali Linux

Kali is a complete top-to-bottom rebuild of BackTrack Linux and is developed, maintained and funded by Offensive

Security. It was born out of the need to create a distribution that is better equipped to handle the needs of a professional pen tester or an ethical hacker.

It has over 300 tools including Wireshark, Nmap, Armitage, Aircrack, Burp Suite, etc. Kali is best suited for people who want to poke holes in a network. It has tools to detect vulnerabilities in network systems. This helps to test the security of the network as a whole, which is, in fact, Kali’s motto, “The best defence is a good offence!”.

Salient features of Kali Linux

- It uses Git as its VCS and supports a large number of wireless devices. As it is FHS (File Hierarchy Standard) compliant software, its users can easily trace the libraries, support files, etc. It has multi-lingual support and is completely customisable, down to the kernel.
- It has root access by default. Usually, in normal Debian distributions, this is not the case as it is a good practice to activate the root only when required. In Kali, though, this approach would be a hindrance as the tools given in the package require admin access. This is another reason why first-time Linux users are discouraged from using this operating system, as they will tend to make mistakes if they are working with root privileges.
- It has network services disabled. This is to keep the system secure against the many packages that will be